

Rainbow International School Website Search Audit

An external assessment of rainbowinternationalschool.in — covering a partially completed platform migration, indexation integrity, published-claim accuracy, brand separation from the pre-school, and the admissions keywords that matter for a CBSE K–12 school in Thane.

[Migration integrity](#)[Technical & indexation](#)[AI search readiness](#)[Claim & brand review](#)[Action plan](#)

Prepared for: Rainbow International School (RIS) — Digital & Marketing
Property: <https://rainbowinternationalschool.in> · Brahmand, Thane West
Board: CBSE, Nursery to Class 12 · Affiliation 1130661 · School Code 30562
Date: 25 July 2026 · **Method:** External, non-authenticated crawl and SERP analysis

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1 Executive summary

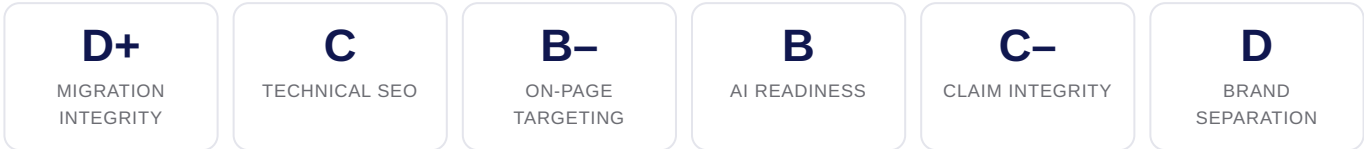
Rainbow International School has recently moved its website onto a new platform, and the move is not finished. That single fact drives most of what follows. Google's index still holds the previous WordPress URL set — pages such as `/amenities/`, `/primary-section/` and `/virtual-learning/`, each of which had accumulated years of ranking history. Those URLs now behave in two different broken ways, and both are costing visibility today.

The headline finding

Of the legacy URLs still listed in Google, one tested URL (`/amenities/`) fails to load at all, returning a **redirect loop**. Another (`/primary-section/`) loads, but serves **the homepage's content and title** instead of the primary-section page a searcher expected. A parent clicking "Top Primary School in Thane" from Google therefore lands either on an error or on a generic homepage. Neither URL was given a proper permanent redirect to a matching new page. Every such URL is leaking accumulated ranking equity, and the ones serving homepage content are creating duplicate-content signals across the whole domain.

Two further issues sit alongside it. **Brand separation between the school and the pre-school has broken down on this domain**: the RIS site hosts a page titled "Best International Preschool in Thane | Rainbow Preschool", lists an award for "10 Best Preschools in India" among the school's accolades, describes an "award-winning preschool wing", and publishes the same admissions phone number used by Rainbow Preschool. This confuses Google about which entity is which, and puts the school's own domain into competition with rainbowpreschools.com for pre-school queries.

And **the same pattern of unverifiable claims found on the pre-school site appears here too** — most notably "1 Lac+ lives impacted", a figure that sits awkwardly beside the school's own stated enrolment of roughly 3,000 students since 2009. Several award claims and repeated superlatives ("Best", "Leading", "Top") compound the issue, and the superlatives also breach Rainbow's own brand rules.



Qualitative expert assessment from externally observable signals. Migration integrity and brand separation are the two urgent problems; AI readiness is genuinely good and better than the pre-school site was before its remediation.

The five priorities

#	Action	Fixes	Urgency
1	Export every legacy URL from Search Console and map each one to a permanent 301 redirect to its closest new equivalent	Lost rankings, broken parent journeys	NOW
2	Fix the redirect loop, and stop unmatched legacy URLs silently serving homepage content	Errors, duplicate content	NOW
3	Give every page its own canonical URL; correct the social-share image pointing at a development domain	Indexation, link previews	HIGH
4	Remove all pre-school content, awards and messaging from the RIS domain; separate the phone numbers	Brand rules, entity clarity	HIGH
5	Verify or remove every unsubstantiated claim and superlative	Trust, brand compliance	HIGH

2 Scope, method — and one step you must take first

What was done. An external, non-authenticated assessment: direct fetches of the homepage, legacy URLs still present in Google's index, `robots.txt`, `llms.txt` and the sitemap; analysis of Google's indexed page set for the domain; and review of the competitive landscape for CBSE admissions queries in Thane.

Mandatory verification before acting on §3 or §6

The Rainbow pre-school site serves different HTML to search-engine crawlers than to ordinary visitors. During its audit, this "dynamic rendering" caused an external crawl to report catastrophic problems that did not exist. If this school site shares that architecture — and the shared Replit deployment and identical `llms.txt` convention suggest it may — then some findings below could be artefacts of the crawler used, exactly as happened before.

Before implementing anything, run the commands in §10.4 to compare what a Googlebot user-agent receives against what a browser receives. That takes five minutes and will confirm or dismiss several findings. This report flags every item that depends on it.

Limits of this assessment

- **No Search Console, Analytics or ranking data** was available. This report therefore contains no traffic, impression, click, position or fee figures — none have been estimated or invented. The single most valuable next step is connecting that data.
- **No source-code access.** Unlike the pre-school engagement, no repository was available for this site, so findings about internal behaviour are inferred from external responses and must be verified.
- **Only a sample of legacy URLs was tested.** The full scale of the migration problem can only be measured from Search Console's index coverage report.

Confirmed facts used in this report

Item	Value (as published by the school)
Board and range	CBSE, Nursery to Class 12; Science, Commerce and Humanities streams at senior secondary
CBSE affiliation	Affiliation number 1130661 · School code 30562 independently verifiable
Founded	April 2009
Campus	3.5 acres, Cosmos Arcade, Brahmand Phase 4, Thane West 400607
Enrolment	3,000+ currently enrolled
Hours	Monday to Saturday, 9:00 AM – 6:00 PM

3 Finding 1 — the migration is only half done CRITICAL

When a website moves platform, the old URLs do not disappear from Google — they remain indexed for months, and every one of them carries accumulated ranking history and inbound links. The only way to transfer that value is to permanently redirect each old URL to its closest equivalent on the new site. That work does not appear to have been done here.

3.1 What Google still lists

Google's index for this domain still returns the previous WordPress URL structure, with titles written for pages that no longer exist in that form:

Legacy URL still indexed	Title Google is showing	Tested outcome
/amenities/	State-of-the-Art School Amenities	REDIRECT LOOP — the page could not be loaded at all
/primary-section/	Top Primary School in Thane	WRONG CONTENT — loads, but returns the homepage's title and content
/virtual-learning/	Innovative Virtual Learning	Not individually tested verify
/international-school-admission-process-guide/	International School Admission Process Explained	Not individually tested verify
/meta-school-2025-26/	Leading Among International Schools in Thane	Not individually tested verify
/rainbow-preschool-international/	Best International Preschool in Thane	See §4 — brand separation issue

3.2 Why each failure mode hurts

Failure A · Redirect loop CRITICAL

A parent who searches and clicks "State-of-the-Art School Amenities" reaches a browser error rather than the school. Google, encountering the same loop, will eventually drop the URL from its index — and because the loop prevents it reading any redirect target, none of that page's accumulated authority transfers anywhere. It is simply lost.

Likely cause: a redirect rule pointing at a URL that itself redirects back, or an HTTP-to-HTTPS or www/non-www rule conflicting with a page-level rule. **Fix:** trace the chain, and ensure every legacy URL resolves to its destination in exactly one hop.

Failure B · Legacy URLs serving homepage content HIGH

/primary-section/ returns HTTP 200 with the homepage's title, description and content. To a parent, this is a dead end — they searched for primary-school information and got a generic page. To Google, it is worse: many different URLs returning identical content is the textbook definition of duplicate content, and because the page also appears to canonicalise to the root domain, Google is being told that all these URLs are really the homepage.

Consequence: the specific, high-intent pages that used to rank for "primary school in Thane" no longer exist as distinct entities, so those rankings have nowhere to live.

Fix: every legacy URL must resolve to exactly one of three outcomes — a 301 to a genuinely equivalent new page, a 301 to the most relevant parent section, or a proper 404/410 if no equivalent exists. Serving homepage content with a 200 status is the one option that must be eliminated.

3.3 How to do this properly

1. **Get the real list.** In Search Console, open Indexing → Pages, and export every URL Google knows about. Also export the "Pages" report from the previous WordPress installation if it is still available, and pull the top pages by clicks from the last 16 months of Performance data. That last export is the priority list — those are the pages actually earning traffic.
2. **Map each one** in a spreadsheet: old URL → new URL → reason. Where no equivalent exists, decide deliberately between redirecting to the nearest section and returning a 404.
3. **Implement as 301s**, single-hop, and confirm each one resolves correctly.
4. **Submit the new sitemap** and use the URL Inspection tool to request re-crawling of the highest-value redirects.
5. **Watch Search Console** weekly for four to six weeks: "Page with redirect", "Not found (404)", "Duplicate without user-selected canonical" and "Soft 404" should all fall.

Prioritise ruthlessly by past traffic. Ten legacy URLs that earned real clicks matter more than a hundred that never did.

4 Finding 2 — brand separation has broken down HIGH

Rainbow operates two distinct brands with separate audiences, positioning and websites: the school (CBSE, Nursery to Class 12) and the pre-school (Playgroup to Kindergarten, at rainbowpreschools.com). The school's own brand rules require these never to be mixed. On this domain, they are.

What appears on the RIS domain	Why it is a problem
A page at <code>/rainbow-preschool-international/</code> titled <i>"Best International Preschool in Thane Rainbow Preschool"</i>	The school's domain is competing with rainbowpreschools.com for pre-school queries. Two Rainbow properties targeting one query split the result, and Google must decide which entity a pre-school search belongs to.
"10 Best Preschools in India" listed among the school's awards	A pre-school accolade presented as a school credential. It weakens the CBSE positioning and muddles the entity.
"Award-winning preschool wing" in the school's key features	Same issue: pre-school messaging inside secondary-school content.
Admissions phone +91 82915 68972 — the same number published by Rainbow Preschool	Shared contact details across two brands is a genuine local-SEO problem. Google uses name, address and phone to distinguish entities; an identical number across two organisations invites it to merge or confuse them, and complicates both Business Profiles.
Homepage positioning oscillates between "CBSE School" and "International School"	The current title says "Best CBSE School in Thane"; indexed legacy titles say "Leading Among International Schools". These target different searcher intents and different fee expectations. Pick one primary identity.

RECOMMENDED

- **Redirect** `/rainbow-preschool-international/` to the equivalent page on rainbowpreschools.com, so the pre-school brand owns pre-school intent and the equity flows to the right property.
- **Remove pre-school awards and messaging** from the school's credentials. If the group wishes to reference its sister brand, do so as a clearly labelled link — as the pre-school site already does in reverse — not as a school credential.
- **Separate the admissions phone numbers.** A distinct number per brand is important for Business Profile integrity, for attribution, and for the parent who calls expecting one and reaches the other.
- **Settle the positioning.** "CBSE school in Thane" is the more searched, more specific and more defensible identity, and it matches the affiliation the school can actually evidence. Use "international" as a descriptor of the school's name and outlook, not as the category claim.

5 Finding 3 — claim integrity and superlatives HIGH

The school publishes a set of factual claims to Google, to AI assistants via `llms.txt`, and to parents. Some are excellent and independently verifiable. Others cannot be substantiated from any public source, and one is arithmetically difficult to reconcile with the school's own figures.

5.1 The claims register

Claim	Status	Assessment
CBSE affiliation 1130661, school code 30562	EXCELLENT	Independently verifiable on CBSE's own portal. This is the single strongest trust signal the school has, and it should be far more prominent — on the homepage, in the footer, and in structured data.
Founded April 2009 · 3.5-acre campus · 3,000+ enrolled	PLAUSIBLE	Specific, internally consistent and checkable. Good practice.
"1 Lac+ lives impacted"	VERIFY	Difficult to reconcile with the school's own numbers. With roughly 3,000 students currently enrolled and seventeen years of operation, reaching 100,000 individuals would require turning over the entire school population nearly six times a year. If the figure counts something broader — community programmes, event attendance, the group across both brands — it must say so explicitly, or it reads as inflated. Notably, an almost identical "1,00,000" claim appears on the pre-school site, which suggests both may share a common, unverified origin.
Times Education Icon Award British Council International School Award NABET accreditation FIT India certification 15th World Education Summit	EVIDENCE	These are all real, recognised programmes — which makes them valuable <i>if</i> the school holds them. Each should carry the award year and the awarding body, and link to the certificate or announcement. An award with a date and a source is persuasive; a bare award name is not, and is easily doubted.
"10 Best Preschools in India"	MOVE	Belongs to the pre-school brand, not the school (\$4).
"24/7 monitoring", smart classrooms, sports facilities	CONFIRM	Standard facility claims; confirm they hold across the whole campus before publishing them as absolutes.

5.2 Superlatives — an SEO habit that breaks the brand rules

The site currently uses superlative claims in prominent positions: the homepage title is *"Best CBSE School in Thane | Nursery to Class 12"*, and indexed pages carry titles such as *"Top Primary School in Thane"*, *"Best International Preschool in Thane"* and *"Leading Among International Schools in Thane"*.

The intent is understandable — parents search "best CBSE school in Thane", and the title matches the query. But Rainbow's brand rules prohibit "Best", "No. 1" and similar unverifiable superlatives, and a self-declared "Best" carries little persuasive weight with a discerning parent while exposing the school to an easy challenge.

How to keep the ranking without the claim

A title can target a query without asserting the superlative. **"CBSE School in Thane West | Nursery to Class 12 | Rainbow International School"** still contains every term a parent types, and adds the specificity — locality, range, name — that actually drives a click. Where genuine third-party recognition exists, state it factually: *"Times Education Icon Award, 2024"* earns far more trust than the word "Best" ever will. Substantiated recognition is the compliant, and more convincing, route to the same rankings.

5.3 What to do

1. Confirm the "1 Lac+" figure or replace it with what the records support — and if it counts something broader than enrolment, define that in the sentence itself.

2. For every award: obtain the year, the awarding body and a verifiable source, then publish all three. Remove any that cannot be evidenced.
3. Rewrite superlative titles into specific, factual ones as above.
4. Elevate the CBSE affiliation number — it is the credential competitors cannot fake.

6 Technical and AI-search findings

Item	Finding and action	Priority
Social image on a development domain	The Open Graph and Twitter image points to <code>rainbow-international.replit.app/opengraph.jpg</code> rather than the live domain. Every share on WhatsApp, Facebook or LinkedIn pulls its preview image from a development URL — which may break, and which exposes the build platform. Worse, if that development domain is publicly reachable it can be indexed as a duplicate of the entire site. Action: point all image and URL metadata at the live domain, and ensure the development domain is either password-protected or blocked from indexing.	HIGH
Canonical tags	No distinct canonical tag was observed, and pages appear to declare the root domain as their URL. Every page needs a self-referencing canonical. Combined with the legacy-URL behaviour in §3, this is likely causing widespread duplicate-content consolidation onto the homepage. verify per §2	HIGH
Body content in raw HTML	External fetches returned metadata but no body content, headings or navigation — the same signature seen on the pre-school site before verification proved it was serving crawlers correctly. This may be entirely fine. Do not act on this without running the §10.4 checks.	VERIFY
robots.txt	STRONG Explicitly permits GPTBot, ClaudeBot and anthropic-ai; disallows only <code>/api/</code> , <code>/ad-google</code> and <code>/ssr-demo/</code> ; references the sitemap plus <code>llms.txt</code> and <code>llms-full.txt</code> . This is better AI positioning than the pre-school site had before its remediation — no changes needed.	GOOD
llms.txt for AI engines	STRONG A structured brief covering sections, academics, features, awards, location and FAQs. Genuinely ahead of the market. Its only weakness is that it faithfully reproduces the unverified claims in §5 — fix those and this becomes a real asset.	CONTENT
Structured data	No schema was observable externally. A CBSE school should publish <code>School / EducationalOrganization</code> markup including the affiliation number, address, geo-coordinates, phone, grade range, and <code>FAQPage</code> on admissions content. verify per §2	HIGH
Cloudflare / CDN caching	If this site sits behind the same Cloudflare account as the pre-school, check for any "Cache Everything" page rule. On the sister site, that setting was caching crawler HTML and serving it to real visitors. Ensure HTML is never edge-cached and Browser Cache TTL is "Respect Existing Headers".	CHECK
Meta keywords tag	Present and detailed. Harmless but ignored by every major search engine since 2009 — no effort should be spent maintaining it.	INFO

7 What is already strong

- **Keyword-aware titles and descriptions.** The homepage targets its query set deliberately, and locality terms (Brahmand, Hiranandani Estate, Ghodbunder Road) are already in play. The instinct is right; only the superlatives need correcting.
- **AI-search readiness ahead of the field.** An open robots.txt for AI crawlers plus `llms.txt` and `llms-full.txt` puts this school ahead of essentially every competitor in Thane on generative search.
- **Verifiable credentials.** CBSE affiliation number and school code are published — a trust asset most competing sites bury or omit.
- **Genuine substance to work with.** A 3.5-acre campus, three senior-secondary streams, 3,000 students and seventeen years of operation give real material for content that does not need embellishment.

- **An existing content library.** The legacy site produced substantial pages — amenities, virtual learning, admission guides. Recovering these through proper redirects is far cheaper than writing replacements.

8 Keyword strategy for a CBSE K–12 school

Admissions searches for a K–12 school differ from pre-school searches: parents research further ahead, compare on board, results, fees and facilities, and search by grade and stream. Demand estimates are qualitative — replace with Search Console data once connected.

TIER 1 — HIGH-INTENT ADMISSIONS

Cluster	Demand	Page that should own it
CBSE school in Thane / Thane West	High	Homepage
CBSE school near me / near Ghodbunder Road / Brahmand / Hiranandani Estate	High	A dedicated location page naming the campus and its landmarks
school admission in Thane 2026-27	High	Admissions page with process, dates and documents
CBSE school fees in Thane	High	Currently unowned. Even without publishing exact fees, a page on what is included and how to request the structure captures this demand.
nursery / Class 1 admission in Thane	Med-High	Grade-entry pages for the two main intake points

TIER 2 — COMPARISON AND RESEARCH

Cluster	Demand	Page
best / top CBSE schools in Thane	High	Homepage plus genuine third-party recognition — aggregators dominate here (\$9)
CBSE vs ICSE vs IB in Thane	Med	A guide article; strong AI-citation candidate
Class 11 streams — Science / Commerce / Humanities	Med	Senior-secondary page, one section per stream
school with transport / sports facilities in Thane	Med	Facilities page — recover the legacy amenities content

TIER 3 — AUTHORITY AND AI CITATIONS

Parent-facing guides that answer real questions and link down to admissions: choosing a board for your child, what CBSE affiliation actually means and how to verify it, admission timelines and documents in Thane, and preparing a child for the Class 11 stream decision. Each should link to two or three Tier-1 pages.

9 Competitive landscape

The searches that matter are dominated by two groups, and each is beaten differently.

Group	Who	How RIS competes
Aggregators	Edustoke, UniApply, EzySchooling, Extramarks, YellowSlate, Mumbai School Directory	They own "best CBSE schools in Thane" and every fees query, and they are what AI assistants quote. You will not outrank them for those terms — so be the best-listed, best-reviewed, most complete school on them. That is faster and cheaper than trying to displace them.
Local CBSE schools	Established Thane CBSE and international schools competing for the same catchment	Compete on the specifics they cannot easily match: verifiable affiliation, campus size, stream choice, seventeen-year track record, and Google Business Profile reviews from current parents.

Strategic read

For a single-campus school, the decisive assets are a complete Google Business Profile with a strong review flow, accurate listings on the aggregators parents and AI engines actually consult, and pages that answer the specific questions parents ask — fees, admission process, streams, transport. The migration must be fixed first, because none of this compounds while indexed URLs are looping or serving the wrong page.

10 Action plan and measurement

10.1 Immediate — this week

Action	Owner	Outcome
Run the verification commands in §10.4 and share the results	Dev	Confirms or dismisses §3 and §6 findings
Connect and review Search Console: export all known URLs and the last 16 months of top pages	Marketing	The real migration scope
Diagnose and fix the redirect loop on /amenities/	Dev	Stops an active error
Check Cloudflare for any "Cache Everything" rule; set Browser Cache TTL to "Respect Existing Headers"	Dev	Prevents the issue found on the sister site
Correct the Open Graph image and URL to the live domain; block the development domain from indexing	Dev	Fixes link previews and duplicate-domain risk

10.2 Weeks 2–4

Action	Owner	Outcome
Build and implement the full legacy-URL redirect map, prioritised by past clicks	Dev + Marketing	Recovers ranking equity
Ensure no URL returns homepage content with a 200 status	Dev	Ends duplicate content
Add self-referencing canonicals and School/EducationalOrganization schema including the affiliation number	Dev	Indexation and rich results
Redirect the pre-school page to rainbowpreschools.com; remove pre-school awards and messaging	Dev + Marketing	Brand separation restored
Separate the admissions phone number from the pre-school's	Leadership	Entity clarity and attribution
Complete the claims verification and rewrite superlative titles	Leadership + Marketing	Trust and brand compliance

10.3 Months 2–3

Action	Owner	Outcome
Build and optimise the Google Business Profile; start a standing parent-review routine	Marketing	Local visibility and enquiries
Claim and complete listings on Edustoke, UniApply, EzySchooling and Extramarks	Marketing	Presence where parents and AI engines look
Publish the fees-information and admissions-process pages	Marketing	Captures unowned high-intent demand
Recover or rewrite the strongest legacy content (amenities, virtual learning, admission guide)	Marketing	Restores topical depth
Publish the Tier-3 parent guides, each linking to admissions pages	Marketing	Authority and AI citations

10.4 Verification commands — run these first

Run in any terminal. The first two determine whether this site uses crawler-side rendering, which changes how several findings above should be read.

Command	What it tells you
<code>curl -s -A "Mozilla/5.0 (compatible; Googlebot/2.1; +http://www.google.com/bot.html)" https://rainbowinternationalschool.in/ head -40</code>	What Google actually sees on the homepage
<code>curl -s -A "Mozilla/5.0 (Windows NT 10.0; Win64; x64)" https://rainbowinternationalschool.in/ head -40</code>	What a parent's browser receives — compare the two
<code>curl -sI -L https://rainbowinternationalschool.in/amenities/ grep -E "HTTP/ location:"</code>	Traces the redirect loop hop by hop
<code>curl -s -o /dev/null -w "%{http_code}\n" https://rainbowinternationalschool.in/primary-section/</code>	Confirms the wrong-content-with-200 problem
<code>curl -sD - -o /dev/null https://rainbowinternationalschool.in/ grep -i "cf-cache-status cache-control"</code>	Whether HTML is being edge-cached
<code>curl -s https://rainbowinternationalschool.in/ grep -o 'rel="canonical" href="[^\"]*"'</code>	Whether canonicals are self-referencing

10.5 What to measure

Metric	Source	Target
Pages with redirect · Not found · Soft 404 · Duplicate without canonical	Search Console → Indexing	All falling week on week after the redirect map ships
Impressions and clicks on admissions keywords	Search Console	Recovery toward pre-migration levels, then growth
Indexed vs submitted URLs	Search Console	The intended page set, no legacy duplicates
Business Profile calls, directions, enquiries	Business Profile	Month-on-month growth
Reviews and rating	Business Profile	Steady velocity from current parents
Admissions enquiry submissions	GA4 and form backend	The bottom line
AI citations for "CBSE school in Thane"	Manual quarterly check	RIS named in AI answers

Expected trajectory, stated honestly

Fixing the migration is recovery work, not growth work — the realistic outcome is regaining visibility the site has already lost, over roughly four to eight weeks as Google reprocesses the redirects. Growth comes afterwards, from the Business Profile, the fees and admissions pages, and genuine third-party recognition replacing self-declared superlatives. No specific forecast is possible without baseline data, and none should be trusted from anyone who offers one without it.

Prepared for the Rainbow International School digital and marketing team, 25 July 2026. Findings are based on externally observable signals; no Search Console, Analytics, Business Profile or source-code access was available, and consequently this report contains no traffic, ranking, conversion or fee figures. Items marked **verify** require confirmation via \$10.4 or from internal records before action. Prepared in line with Rainbow brand guidance: RIS identity only, confident and trust-first, and no claim published without support.